Yes, **TPB is supported** for **charitable donation intention**, though support is stronger for intention than behavior.

1. Introduction

TPB is supported for charitable donation intention across this corpus. The strongest evidence is a 2023 systematic review and meta-analysis of 117 samples, which found strong support for TPB in predicting intention across blood, organ, time, and money donation, with moderate-to-strong positive associations for the expected pathways and 44% of intention variance explained by the standard TPB predictors (White et al., 2023). Earlier monetary-giving studies converge on the same conclusion: the original TPB constructs predict donation intention, and revised or extended TPB models usually predict it better by adding moral norm and past behavior (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016).

Support also generalizes across contexts rather than depending on one charity type or one country. Positive TPB results appear in Canada, Spain, China, Japan, Malaysia, Indonesia, Kuwait, and the Philippines, spanning offline monetary giving, online giving, crowdfunding, heritage donations, and donation-program participation (Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Pérez & Egea, 2019; Li et al., 2022). The most stable predictors are perceived behavioral control, attitude, and moral norm, while subjective norm is more variable across settings and populations (White et al., 2023; Linden, 2011; Liu & Han, 2023). The main limitation is not whether TPB predicts intention, but that actual donation behavior is harder to explain consistently (White et al., 2023; Holdershaw et al., 2011; Lakew et al., 2026).

Is TPB supported for charitable donation intention? N = 39

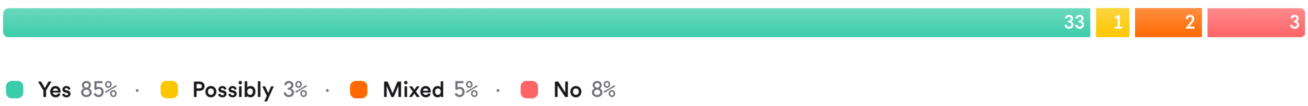

FIGURE 1 Consensus on TPB support for donation intentions

The meter should read strongly positive. The literature includes one large donation-specific meta-analysis and many replications across donation forms, with disagreement mainly about which TPB predictors matter most in each context rather than about whether TPB predicts intention at all (White et al., 2023; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Jauhara et al., 2025).

2. Methods

This Deep Search review was run over more than 170 million research papers indexed in Consensus, including Semantic Scholar, PubMed, and other academic sources. The search began with a yes/no query on TPB support for charitable donation intention, expanded through citation crawling and targeted searches on charitable giving, model extensions, empirical syntheses, cross-cultural tests, online donation, and trust or branding links. Relevance filtering then narrowed the results to the highest-yield studies for synthesis.

A total of 93 unique papers were identified after deduplication, 237 papers were screened through machine-learned relevance filtering, 93 were eligible at the thresholding stage, and 50 papers were included in the final review.

Search Strategy

84.3M	1.5K	50
Retrieved	Eligible	Included

22 searches

1 citation graph use

All papers retrieved from 22 searches and 1 citation graph use.

Papers meeting relevance and quality criteria, after deduplication

Top papers selected to be included in the final analysis

FIGURE 2 Deep search screening and paper inclusion flow

Searches combined TPB core constructs, donation subtypes, model extensions, cultural comparisons, and adjacent trust or brand factors.

3. Results

3.1 Key Papers

Three papers anchor this literature for different reasons: the 2023 meta-analysis establishes the broadest donation-specific evidence base, the 2007 revised TPB study is the foundational monetary-giving test, and the 2016 comparison study shows revised TPB outperforming TRA and standard TPB for monetary donation (White et al., 2023; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016).

Paper	Summary
(White et al., 2023)	Meta-analytic support across donation types (White et al., 2023)
(Smith & McSweeney, 2007)	Original TPB predicts money-giving intention (Smith & McSweeney, 2007)
(Torrent-Sellens et al., 2021)	Revised TPB predicts intention best (Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016)

FIGURE 3 Anchor papers in TPB donation literature

3.2 Core Predictors

The best overall estimate is that TPB explains a large share of charitable donation intention, especially once moral norm is included. In the 2023 meta-analysis, perceived behavioral control was the strongest correlate of intention, followed closely by moral norm, attitude, and subjective norm (White et al., 2023). The same pattern appears in younger donors, where an extended TPB explained 61% of variance in donation intention and identified attitude, perceived behavioral control, moral norm, and past behavior as significant predictors (Knowles et al., 2012).

Dimension	Broad Charitable Giving	Youth Money Giving	Blood Donation	Citations
Variance explained	44% standard TPB	61% extended TPB	70-86% in extended models	(White et al., 2023; Knowles et al., 2012; Robinson et al., 2008)

Dimension	Broad Charitable Giving	Youth Money Giving	Blood Donation	Citations
Most stable predictors	PBC, attitude, moral norm	PBC, attitude, moral norm	PBC, self-efficacy, norms	(White et al., 2023; Knowles et al., 2012; Lakew et al., 2026)
Subjective norm	Moderate overall	Sometimes nonsignificant	Often significant	(White et al., 2023; Knowles et al., 2012; Liu & Han, 2023)
Behavior prediction	Weaker than intention	Limited follow-up	Better in donor cohorts	(White et al., 2023; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Masser et al., 2009)

FIGURE 4 Predictor patterns across donation contexts

A key difference is that subjective norm is inconsistent. It was nonsignificant in some money-donation samples in Canada and among young donors (Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Knowles et al., 2012). But it remained significant in Chinese online donation, blood donation, waqf participation, and Indonesian fandom giving, suggesting strong contextual moderation by culture and social setting (Li et al., 2022; Liu & Han, 2023; Shaamirova et al., 2026).

3.3 Extensions and Boundary Conditions

Revised and extended TPB models usually outperform the standard model for charitable giving because donation is a moralized and socially embedded behavior. Moral norm was the strongest predictor in one revised charitable-intent study and helped produce nearly 70% explained variance in intention (Linden, 2011). Past behavior repeatedly improved intention models in Canada, Spain, crowdfunding, and early revised monetary-donation work (Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Pérez & Egea, 2019; Kusuma & Anafisati, 2020).

Some studies also extend TPB with trust, knowledge, identity, or contextual variables. Trust in charity organizations positively predicted online donation intention in China, while trust in technology did not (Li et al., 2022). Knowledge improved model fit in African culturally and linguistically diverse communities by acting indirectly through self-efficacy, norms, and attitudes (Polonsky et al., 2013). Heritage awareness, relationship strength, and personal relevance also strengthened intention or intention-to-behavior conversion in newer platform-based and heritage-donation studies (Li et al., 2024; Zhou & Xue, 2024).

3.4 Contradictions and Exceptions

Support is strong, but not universal. In one Malaysian study, the extended TPB fit the data well overall, yet attitude, descriptive norm, and moral norm did not significantly contribute to money-donation intention (Kashif et al., 2015). In Uzbekistan, one recent study found that traditional TPB factors such as attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control were not supported, with income and happiness instead driving charitable behavior (Musamuxamedov et al., 2025).

Some exceptions concern intention-behavior translation rather than intention prediction. Blood donation studies repeatedly note that TPB predicts intention better than actual donation behavior (Torrent-Sellens et al., 2021; Holdershaw et al., 2011; Lakew et al., 2026). Human milk donation was a stronger challenge: about half of intention variance was explained, but intention had very little influence on behavior, leading the authors to conclude TPB may not be recommended for that behavior (Pinheiro et al., 2024).

Results Timeline

The literature has progressed from early single-context tests to broad cross-context synthesis.

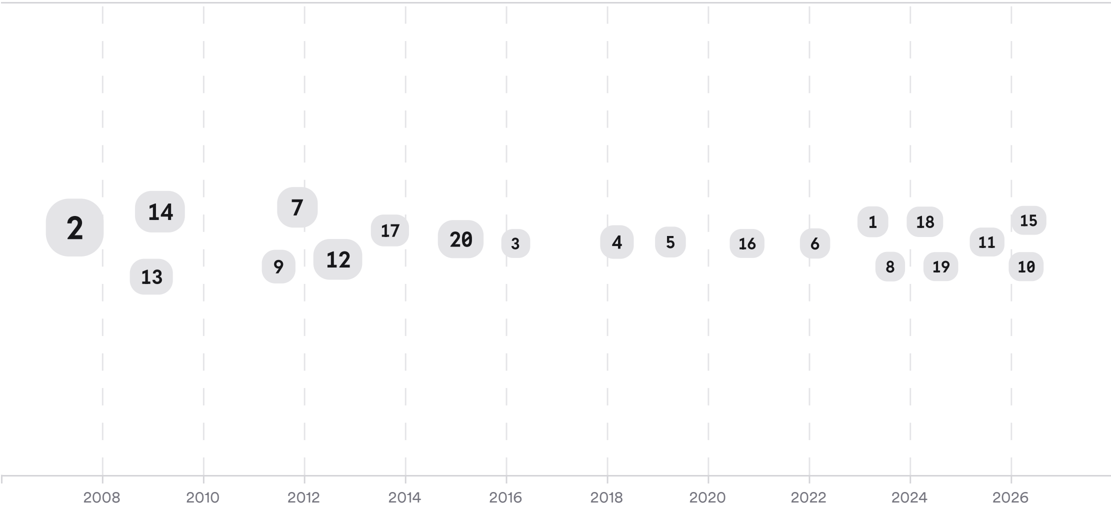

FIGURE 5 Timeline of TPB donation research, larger markers indicate more citations

The overall arc shows early support in blood and monetary giving, followed by extended TPB models emphasizing moral norm and past behavior, and then more recent online, platform, and cross-cultural applications (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Robinson et al., 2008; Zhou & Xue, 2024).

Top Contributors

Across these 50 included papers, **K. White**, **M. K. Hyde**, and **Muhammad Kashif** appear most often, and the most recurrent journals are **PLOS One**, **Transfusion**, and **VOLUNTAS** (White et al., 2023; Knowles et al., 2012; Kashif et al., 2015).

Type	Name	Papers
Author	K. White	[70427c1f5d3b505c91826bd031ad9829][8f443cb4ed5a5251bb6c01b2625f761c] [74340b856ad25656bfd97b344daa30b0][0fa1c99e5afa533b8ef0675d74ed7ae3] [71fbe6f6624557de8f4eb830913d29b1][6ed767ee53dc5944b905bb6bfc716b9e] [da95194a963751bea3cc2f05a0ff3bc9]
Author	M. K. Hyde	[8f443cb4ed5a5251bb6c01b2625f761c][74340b856ad25656bfd97b344daa30b0] [0fa1c99e5afa533b8ef0675d74ed7ae3][71fbe6f6624557de8f4eb830913d29b1] [da95194a963751bea3cc2f05a0ff3bc9]
Author	Muhammad Kashif	[879223c222cb542ba6c7fa8dbb62f4a6][998fc3ea423252a7a9ec77d7519b8a0b]
Journal	*PLOS One*	[70427c1f5d3b505c91826bd031ad9829][9ad323b1cb63585889f1ffce80e33686]
Journal	*Transfusion*	[74340b856ad25656bfd97b344daa30b0][0fa1c99e5afa533b8ef0675d74ed7ae3] [2f2fc9d180d25ccda0e169e2b53967d6]
Journal	*VOLUNTAS: International Journal of Voluntary and Nonprofit Organizations*	[8d0bcac07d9858bbb237aa81f95315e7][6ac275b1c0a95632aa1150ed80bf98f7] [00f0a7c402bb5f12a7f3fb2f867ecfeb]

FIGURE 6 Authors and journals that appeared most frequently in the included papers

4. Discussion

The overall evidence is strongest for the narrow claim the user asked: TPB is supported for **charitable donation intention**. That conclusion rests on one large donation-specific meta-analysis, several well-cited monetary-giving studies, and many replications across blood, organ, online, and platform-mediated giving (White et al., 2023; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Rocheleau, 2013). The field is methodologically repetitive, with many cross-sectional surveys, but the convergence across populations and contexts still makes the basic conclusion robust (White et al., 2023; Obadă et al., 2024; Lakew et al., 2026).

The main scientific nuance is that support for TPB does not mean equal support for every TPB path. Perceived behavioral control is the most stable predictor across the corpus, while subjective norm is notably context-sensitive and sometimes drops out entirely (White et al., 2023; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Shaamirova et al., 2026). Moral norm and past behavior often add substantial explanatory power, which implies that standard TPB captures much of donor intention but not all of the psychologically relevant content for altruistic acts (White et al., 2023; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Delaney & White, 2015).

A second nuance is that behavior is the harder target. Even where TPB explains intentions well, actual donation is more contingent on timing, opportunities, barriers, prior experience, and setting-specific constraints (White et al., 2023; Li et al., 2024; Pinheiro et al., 2024). That gap explains why extended models adding trust, knowledge, moral obligation, or contextual variables are common and often more useful for intervention design (Li et al., 2022; Polonsky et al., 2013; Lakew et al., 2026).

Claim	Evidence Strength	Reasoning	Papers
TPB predicts **charitable donation intention** across multiple donation forms	Strong	Supported by a large meta-analysis plus many replications across money, blood, organ, time, and online giving	(White et al., 2023; Rocheleau, 2013; Jauhara et al., 2025)
Extended TPB usually predicts intention better than standard TPB	Strong	Moral norm and past behavior repeatedly improve explained variance in monetary and health-related donation studies	(Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016; Lakew et al., 2026)
Perceived behavioral control is the most stable core predictor	Strong	It is the strongest overall predictor in the meta-analysis and remains important across diverse donation contexts	(White et al., 2023; Li et al., 2024; Balochi et al., 2023)
TPB predicts **behavior** as well as intention	Moderate	Evidence is weaker because intention-behavior gaps recur in charitable, blood, and milk donation studies	(White et al., 2023; Holdershaw et al., 2011; Pinheiro et al., 2024)
TPB is **universally supported** across all charitable contexts	Weak	Several studies report nonsignificant core paths or poor fit in specific cultural or behavioral settings	(Kashif et al., 2015; Musamuxamedov et al., 2025; Pinheiro et al., 2024)

FIGURE 7 Key claims and supporting evidence identified in these papers

5. Conclusion

The literature supports TPB for charitable donation intention. The strongest evidence comes from a large meta-analysis and a mature set of replication studies showing that attitude, perceived behavioral control, subjective norm, and especially moral norm or past behavior explain substantial variance in planned giving, even though prediction of actual behavior is less consistent.

Research Gaps

The major gaps are less about whether TPB works and more about where it works less well, how intention becomes behavior, and which extensions travel across cultures and donation types.

Topic/Outcome	Longitudinal behavior	Cross-cultural tests	Digital donation	Model extensions
Monetary charity	4	4	2	8
Blood donation	10	6	3	10
Organ/body donation	5	3	GAP	6
Online/social media giving	2	5	8	5
Intention-behavior gap	3	2	2	4

FIGURE 8 Research coverage gaps across donation subtopics

Open Research Questions

Future work should test not just whether TPB predicts intention, but which added constructs best explain donation follow-through.

Question	Why
Which contextual barriers most strongly explain why charitable donation intentions fail to become actual donations?	Repeated intention-behavior gaps suggest practical constraints matter as much as beliefs.
Do moral norm and past behavior improve TPB equally across cultures, religions, and digital donation settings?	These extensions often help, but effect patterns vary sharply by context.
Can trust, knowledge, or brand reputation be integrated into TPB to improve prediction of repeated charitable giving?	Newer studies suggest these constructs matter, but evidence is still fragmented.

FIGURE 9 Open questions for future TPB donation research

For charitable donation intention, TPB is clearly supported, but the best-performing models are usually extended rather than purely standard TPB.

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